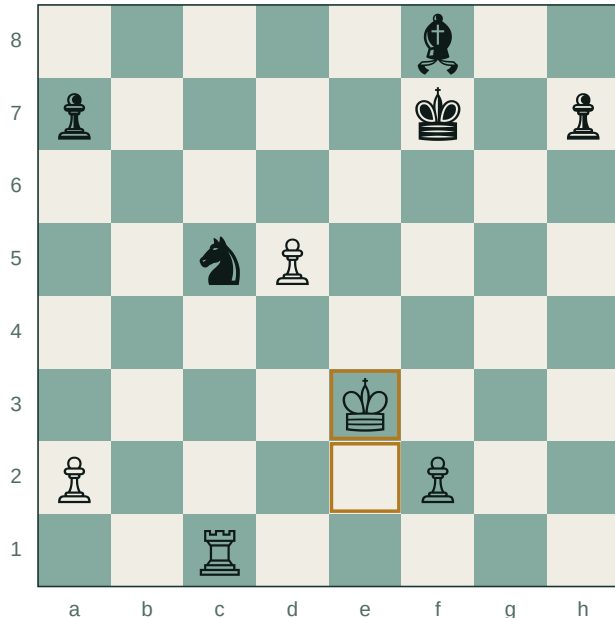


Exposed-king tactics: Black, move 35

Exposed-king tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 35.Ke3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

35...Bh6+ 36. f4 Bxf4+ 37. Kxf4 Nd3+ 38. Kf5 Nxc1

35...Bh6+ Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **36.f4**.

36...Bxf4+ Check restricts White to 5 legal replies here. The move also takes the pawn on f4. Recorded reply: **37.Kxf4**.

37...Nd3+ Check restricts White to 7 legal replies here. From d3 it attacks king on f4 and rook on c1. Recorded reply: **38.Kf5**.

38...Nxc1 The knight captures the rook on c1.

At the end, nominal material is White 2 / Black 5 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +3:** the balance goes from +0 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A king without pawns is not automatically mated. Count active attackers and examine escapes toward friendly pieces.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An exposed king gives the attacker checks and access to nearby squares. Coordinate pieces so the checks drive it into a worse net rather than toward safety.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect open files, diagonals, and unprotected squares around the king. Calculate checks in an order that preserves the attack.

The defending king is on e3. Geometrically undefended: rook on c1. Check for tactical protection.